

able is LochMaster 3.0.

What's Special?

Loch Master software lets the user design, document and test boards. It comes with features like auto generation of component list, a connection test, and a large library with editable symbols and components. The component library includes standard components list. The developer can also develop his own components and extend the existing library.

Loch Master comes with various predefined standard boards. But, the developer has the freedom to draw his own board specifications with the integrated board editor. Further, a component list can be generated from the component data. Test mode allows the developer to follow the flow of the signal and identify any unwanted signals. The x-ray function allows him to edit the board on both sides. Once the design is ready, the developer gets various options to print the design.

Users' feedback

LochMaster 3.0 makes the components look real. Some of its major improvements over the earlier versions are x-ray view (it makes the board visible on the other side), Undo (it was missing in version 1.0 of the software) and many predefined boards (these were missing in version 2.0). For verifying the design, the developer can use the testing mode. By clicking a point on the board, he can find out all the other points of the board that are connected to it.

Suggestion

The demo version should have save, print and export functions.

Distributor

One can order the software either on a CD or as a download. More information about cost and shipping charges can be found at 'www.abacom-online.de/uk/html/bestellung.html.' There are no distributors in India for the software. All the purchases are to be made online.

Home Page: <http://www.abacom-online.de/uk/default.html>

Download URL: <http://www.abacom-online.de/uk/html/demoversionen.html>

Platform Support: Windows

VeroDes



VeroDes is easy to use. The latest version available is VeroDes 1.35.

What's Special?

The software allows board sizes up to 70 holes by 70 tracks. It gives the users the flexibility to look at both sides of the board, with links, breaks and component pins clearly marked in either way. They can print the circuit in various ways – print current board as seen in the component-side view of the editor or as seen in the copper-side view of the editor.

Rick says, "In future, I would like to do floating pins where a two-legged component (resistor) can have one pin placed and the other pin dragged down to the track desired. I would also like to support more than one vertical wire link along the same column. If you imagine an eight-bit computer, like a Z80 or 6502 design, you'll realise that with eight data lines, sixteen address lines and another few for control it could get messy."

Users' feedback

VeroDes comes with some very useful features. It can highlight all the components that are connected directly to the ground. Users can create their own components, up to 25x25 pins in dimensions (or 600 pins in total), along with lines, rectangles and circles for drawing the component body. Component rotation is possible and the boards can shrink on all sides.

There is rarely any major improvement in VeroDes, just additions and enhancements. Recently, an auto-upgrader was added to the software, so the user can check for updates.

Suggestion

Latest PCs run on Windows 7, so it would be great if VeroDes too supports Windows 7.

Distributor

The software is free and can be downloaded online from 'www.heyrick.co.uk/software/verodes/index.html' Since it is a free software, there is no dedicated distributor for it.

Home Page: <http://www.heyrick.co.uk/software/verodes/index.html>

Download URL: <http://www.heyrick.co.uk/software/verodes/index.html>

Platform Support: Windows

DIY Layout Creator



DIY Layout Creator is easy to use because of the layout of the user interface. Anyone can use it to draw board layouts for the PCB and Stripboard.

What's Special?

The software allows the user to place the components on the board with just a few clicks. The user just needs to click the source and destination holes and the software takes care of placing the components in between. When talking about ICs, there too the user just needs to connect pin 1 to the source hole and the last pin goes to the destination hole. The software also allows printouts, which can be transferred to the blank board.

Users' feedback

The software is easy to use and the users can create their components such as resistors, capacitors, jumpers, traces and diodes. A transistor can be placed into the software with just two holes. The best feature of the software is that it comes with a lot of predefined components.

Suggestion

The links of the software are no longer working. But, it is a good software for beginners, as it is simple to use.

Home Page: <http://www.storm-software.co.yu/diy>

Download URL: <http://www.storm-software.co.yu/diy>

Platform Support: Windows ●

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